- **Reverse Smocking**

This type of smocking is reversible. Patterns are seen on both the sides. No thread is visible on right and wrong sides of the fabric.

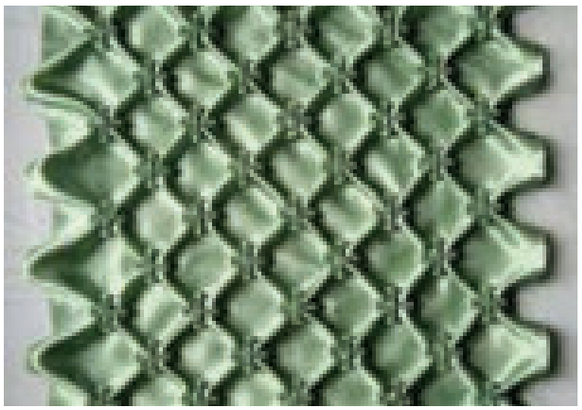


Figure 9.28 Reverse Smocking

Summary for Smocking

Smocking is a technique of creating wavy patterns on fabric and garments. Unlike embroidery more fabric is required for smocking. There are different techniques used to complete the pattern. Techniques and materials followed for each of the smocking type vary from region to region. English smocking, American smocking and Canadian smocking are the three types of smocking frequently used by the designers. Smocking is a common feature in girls and women garments. It also finds its application in home textile products such as cushions, wall hangings and so on. Today's contemporary designers introduce smocked fashion accessories in the market too.

9.5 Traditional Embroidery

Embroidery is one of the many great methods of applied decoration. But it requires good skill, time and artistic ability. Embroidery may be made by hand or machine. Traditional Embroidery vary from region to region and are explained as follows;

9.5.1 Chikankari Embroidery

Region

Chikankari is whitework embroidery practiced in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh. It is believed that Nur Jahan, wife of Mughal emperor Jahangir embroidered a cap for her husband, and hence familiarized this craft of white on white embroidery.

Technique

The embroidery is done on fine white cotton fabric with untwisted white cotton or silk thread. There are three types of stitches used in chikankari :

- flat stitches are made with stem stitch
- herringbone stitch is used for raised stitches like bullion and french knots
- pulled thread work or jali work is done

Motifs

The motifs are inspired by nature's flora including flowers, foliages, creepers, flowering stems, mango, almond, peacock, parrot etc.

Style of Embroidery

A common style present in each piece of Chikankari is the shadow work. To create a shaded effect, herringbone stitch is worked from the wrong side of the fabric. This creates a shadow of lighter colour on the right side. It imparts an outline to the motif on the right side. If worked from the right side of the fabric, double back stitch is used.

End Use

Traditionally the embroidery was done largely for male garments such as kurta, bandi, choga etc. for summer wear. Currently,

XII TDD_English version CHAPTER 09.indd 138 1/13/2020 3:25:48 PM